CITY OF SAN MATEO

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Agenda Report

Agenda Number: {{item.number}} Section Name: {{section.name}} Account Number: 10-5141 File ID: {{item.tracking_number}}

TO: City Council

FROM: Alex Khojikian, City Manager

PREPARED BY: Police Department

MEETING DATE: [INSERT MEETING DATE]

SUBJECT:

Axon Outpost Automated License Plate Recognition System - 18-Month Trial

RECOMMENDATION:

Approve Amendment No. [INSERT AMENDMENT NUMBER] to the City's master services and purchasing agreement with Axon Enterprise, Inc., authorizing an 18-month trial of up to 54 Axon Outpost fixed automated license plate recognition cameras in an amount not to exceed $[INSERT TRIAL AMOUNT]; authorize the Chief of Police to execute the amendment in substantially the form presented; and direct staff to return to the City Council before entering into a long-term fixed ALPR agreement.

BACKGROUND:

Automated license plate recognition (ALPR) is an investigative and public-safety tool that captures license plate and vehicle information from vehicles traveling on public roadways. Alerts can assist in identifying stolen vehicles, vehicles associated with wanted or missing persons, and vehicles connected to serious investigations. ALPR information is an investigative lead only; officers must visually confirm the plate and independently verify an alert before taking enforcement action.

SMPD currently uses Axon body-worn cameras, Fleet 3 in-car video and mobile ALPR, Axon Evidence, and Axon Fusus. These systems support the Real Time Intelligence Center by bringing alerts, live information, digital evidence, and investigative workflows into a common operating environment. Fixed cameras would supplement mobile ALPR by providing consistent coverage at strategically selected roadways.

Vendor comparison. Staff evaluated fixed ALPR systems from Axon Enterprise, Inc., Flock Safety, and Motorola Solutions based on cost, performance, deployment, support, investigative tools, data ownership, retention, auditing, sharing, integration, political considerations, and community trust. Motorola presented the lowest normalized core-camera cost, and Flock offered a mature, rapidly deployable network. Axon received the strongest overall assessment because it best fits SMPD's existing technology environment and provides a unified workflow for alerts, real-time operations, evidence, permissions, retention, and audits.

Axon Outpost is a solar-capable fixed ALPR platform that provides vehicle information, real-time alerts, and visual context to authorized users. Because SMPD already operates Fleet 3, Evidence, and Fusus, the trial can use familiar accounts, security controls, audits, and evidence workflows instead of creating a separate operational platform.

18-month evaluation. Staff recommends a trial rather than an immediate long-term procurement because performance varies with roadway geometry, lane configuration, speed, lighting, weather, plate condition, cellular coverage, solar exposure, and installation angle. The trial will allow SMPD to evaluate Axon under actual San Mateo conditions and compare its performance and value with other products before recommending a permanent solution.

Staff will measure uptime, plate-read accuracy, false and misread rates, day and night performance, alert latency, investigative value, maintenance response, administrative workload, and integration with Fusus and Evidence. The review will also consider alert outcomes, user compliance, audit findings, community feedback, and public-reporting capability. Periodic reviews will be conducted, followed by a final evaluation at the end of the 18-month period.

Privacy and accountability. The trial will operate under existing SMPD policy and California law. Access will be limited to authorized personnel for legitimate law-enforcement purposes, non-evidentiary data will be deleted under Department

retention policy, and records needed for investigations will be preserved through established evidence procedures. Searches, access, exports, and sharing will be logged and audited. The trial does not expand authorized uses or permit prohibited immigration-enforcement or other unauthorized access.

The trial allows SMPD to gain operational experience, validate vendor representations, identify policy or technical concerns, and engage the community before making a long-term commitment. At its conclusion, staff will return to the City Council with results and a recommendation to continue with Axon, select another vendor, modify the scope, or discontinue the program. No long-term procurement is authorized by this action.

BUDGET IMPACT:

The not-to-exceed cost of the 18-month trial is $[INSERT TRIAL AMOUNT], including hardware, software, connectivity, installation, maintenance, support, and removal or disposition of trial equipment. Funding is available in the Police Department's [INSERT FUNDING SOURCE] budget, account 10-5141. No expenditure or commitment beyond the trial is authorized; any long-term agreement will require separate City Council approval.

ENVIRONMENTAL DETERMINATION:

This action is categorically exempt from the California Environmental Quality Act under CEQA Guidelines Sections 15301 and 15303 because it consists of minor alterations to existing public facilities and the installation of small public-safety equipment. The final environmental determination will be confirmed based on the approved installation locations.

NOTICE PROVIDED

All meeting noticing requirements were met.

ATTACHMENTS

Att 1 - Proposed Amendment No. [INSERT AMENDMENT NUMBER]Att 2 - Fixed ALPR Vendor Comparison
Att 3 - San Mateo Police Department ALPR Policy

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